

Ὠριγένης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς

Origen of Alexandria Against Celsus and on Principles

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Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή Χριστιανική [Christian Koine](#)
Domain: Θεολογία [Theology](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Christian](#)

Origen of Alexandria was a major Christian theologian and scholar who lived from approximately 185 to 254 CE. Born in Egypt to a Christian family, he was profoundly affected by the martyrdom of his father during his youth, an event that reportedly strengthened his own religious dedication. He received an extensive education in both Christian teachings and Greek philosophy.

Origen led the Catechetical School in Alexandria before a dispute with his bishop led him to relocate to Caesarea in Palestine, where he founded a new school. He was imprisoned and tortured during a period of persecution later in his life, which likely contributed to his death. He was an extraordinarily prolific writer. His most significant works include **On First Principles**, an early attempt to create a systematic Christian theology, and the **Hexapla**, a massive six-column edition of the Old Testament for textual comparison, though most of it is now lost. He also wrote the apologetic treatise **Against Celsus**, numerous biblical commentaries, and hundreds of homilies. Many of his works survive only in fragments or in later Latin translations.

Origen is considered one of the most influential figures in early Christian thought. He was the first to construct a comprehensive theological system that integrated Greek philosophical concepts with Christian scripture. His method of allegorical biblical interpretation, which sought deeper spiritual meanings, became foundational for centuries of Christian exegesis. However, some of his speculative theological ideas, such as the pre-existence of souls, were later condemned as unorthodox, which complicated his legacy even as his interpretive methods remained widely used.

Works (25)

- Κατὰ Κέλσου · [Against Celsus](#) · 647 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς Γένεσιν · [Commentaries-Genesis](#) · 29 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὴν πρὸς Ῥωμαίους · [Commentaries-Romans](#) · 172 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὴν πρὸς Ῥωμαίους · [Commentaries-Romans III.5–V.7](#) · 52 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὴν πρὸς Ῥωμαίους Ἐπιστολὴν · [Commentaries-the Epistle to the Romans](#) · 16 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὴν πρὸς Ῥωμαίους Ἐπιστολὴν · [Commentaries-the Epistle to the Romans I.1–XII.21](#) · 58 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ἰωάννην Εὐαγγέλιον · [Commentaries-the Gospel of John](#) · 1045 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ἰωάννην Εὐαγγέλιον · [Commentaries-the Gospel of John](#) · 2838 passages

- [Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ματθαῖον Εὐαγγέλιον Βιβλία · Commentary-the Gospel of Matthew Books 10–11 · 73 passages](#)
- [Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ματθαῖον Εὐαγγέλιον Βιβλία · Commentary-the Gospel of Matthew Books 12–17 · 431 passages](#)
- [Διάλογος πρὸς Ἡρακλείδην · Dialogue with Heraclides · 29 passages](#)
- [Ἀποσπάσματα ἐκ Ὑπομνημάτων εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ματθαῖον · Fragments from Commentaries-the Gospel of Matthew · 4 passages](#)
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀρχῶν · Fragments-Principles · 33 passages](#)
- [Ἀποσπάσματα εἰς τὸ Κατὰ Ματθαῖον · Fragments-the Gospel of Matthew · 5 passages](#)
- [Πρὸς Ἀφρικανόν · Letter to Africanus · 23 passages](#)
- [Πρὸς Γρηγόριον τὸν Θαυματουργόν · Letter to Gregory the Wonderworker · 4 passages](#)
- [Περὶ προσευχῆς · On Prayer · 148 passages](#)
- [Περὶ Ἀρχῶν · On Principles · 53 passages](#)
- [Περὶ Ἀναστάσεως · On the Resurrection, Two Books, Fragments · 1 passages](#)
- [Περὶ ᾠσματος ᾠμάτων · On the Song of Songs, Two Books Written in Youth · 1 passages](#)
- [Φιλοκαλία ἢ Ἐπιλογὴ ἐκ τῶν Ἀρίστων Ὀριγένους · Origen's Philocalia, Chapters 23, 25–27 · 54 passages](#)
- [Ἄλλα Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀρχῶν · Other Fragments-Principles · 1 passages](#)
- [Φιλοκαλία · Philocalia · 285 passages](#)
- [Σχόλια εἰς ᾠμα ᾠμάτων · Scholia-Song of Songs · 22 passages](#)
- [Δέκα Βιβλία περὶ ᾠσματος ᾠμάτων · Ten Books-the Song of Songs · 51 passages](#)

Other Christian Authors

- [Αἰνείας ὁ Γαζαῖος · Aeneas of Gaza · 2 works](#)
- [Ἀνατόλιος Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Anatolius of Alexandria · 1 work](#)
- [Ἀθηναγόρας ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Athenagoras of Athens · 2 works](#)
- [Βούθηρος · Butherus · 1 work](#)
- [Κλήμης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Clement of Alexandria · 5 works](#)
- [Εὐσέβιος ὁ Καίσαρειας · Eusebius of Caesarea · 7 works](#)
- [Ἱππόλυτος ὁ Ῥωμαῖος · Hippolytus of Rome · 13 works](#)
- [Ἰωάννης ὁ Φιλόπωνος · John Philoponus of Alexandria · 11 works](#)
- [Νεμέσιος ὁ Ἐμέσης · Nemesius of Emesa · 1 work](#)
- [Σεντεντιῶν Σέκστου · Sententiae Sexti · 1 work](#)
- [Τατιανὸς ὁ Ἀσσύριος · Tatian the Assyrian · 1 work](#)
- [Θεοδώρητος ὁ Κύρρου · Theodoret of Cyrus · 7 works](#)